Class 10 English — Questions, Answers, Meanings & Quick Revision Keywords

Clean typed revision set extracted from the supplied photographs.

THE THIEF'S STORY

1. Had Anil really forgiven Hari Singh? Support the answer with evidence from the text.

Answer: Yes, Anil had really forgiven Hari Singh. Although Anil knew that Hari Singh had stolen his money, he did not confront or punish him. The next morning, Anil behaved normally and gave Hari Singh a fifty-rupee note, telling him that he would be paid regularly. He also promised to teach him to write whole sentences. Anil's calm behaviour and willingness to continue teaching show that he had forgiven Hari and wanted to give him another chance.

> Question meaning: Did Anil actually forgive Hari for stealing his money? "Support with evidence" means giving events from the story that prove the answer.
>
> Quick revision keywords: YES → knew theft → no punishment → behaved normally → fifty-rupee note → regular payment → continued teaching → second chance

2. How did Anil successfully handle the situation without addressing it directly?

Answer: Anil understood that Hari Singh had stolen the money, but he chose not to expose him directly. Instead of scolding or punishing Hari, Anil behaved normally. His silence made Hari realise that Anil knew about the theft but was giving him an opportunity to change. Anil's compassionate response affected Hari deeply. He understood that education, trust and kindness were more valuable than stolen money. Thus, Anil handled the situation wisely and helped Hari begin his moral transformation.

> Question meaning: Anil knew Hari had stolen the money, but instead of openly confronting him, he remained calm, behaved normally and silently gave Hari a chance to change.
>
> Quick revision keywords: Knew theft → silence → no confrontation → normal behaviour → opportunity → Hari realised mistake → change

3. Analyse the role of Anil as a catalyst in Hari Singh's moral development.

Answer: Anil plays a major role in Hari Singh's moral development. Initially, Hari is a young thief who plans to exploit Anil's kindness. However, Anil trusts him, gives him food and shelter, and promises to educate him. When Hari steals the money, Anil does not punish or humiliate him. Instead, he silently forgives him and continues to teach him. Anil's kindness, trust and willingness to educate Hari make him realise that an honest life is more valuable than a life of theft.

> Question meaning: "Catalyst" means something or someone that causes a change. "Moral development" means Hari becoming more honest and morally responsible.
>
> Quick revision keywords: Catalyst → change → trust → food/shelter → education → kindness → forgiveness → honesty → transformation

4. Briefly evaluate the validity of the adage "Values are caught, not taught" in the context of the relationship between Anil and Hari Singh.

Answer: The adage means that people often learn values through observing and experiencing the behaviour of others rather than merely through instructions. This is clearly seen in Anil and Hari's relationship. Anil never gives Hari a long lecture about honesty. Instead, he demonstrates kindness, trust and forgiveness through his actions. Hari gradually learns these values from Anil's behaviour. Therefore, the story strongly supports the idea that values are often caught through example rather than taught through words.

> Question meaning: An adage is a saying or proverb. "Caught, not taught" means that people can learn values by watching someone's behaviour, not just by being told what to do.
>
> Quick revision keywords: Values → learned by example → Anil's kindness → trust → forgiveness → no lecture → Hari observes → becomes honest

5. Interpret Anil's silence after discovering the theft. What does it communicate?

Answer: Anil's silence communicates forgiveness, understanding and trust. He knows that Hari has stolen his money, but he does not openly accuse him. Instead, he gives Hari an opportunity to correct his mistake. His silence also shows that he understands Hari's circumstances and believes that Hari can change. Thus, Anil's silence becomes a powerful form of moral guidance.

Question meaning: The question asks what Anil's silence shows: forgiveness, understanding, trust and giving Hari another chance.

Quick revision keywords: Silence → awareness → forgiveness → understanding → trust → second chance → moral guidance

6. Analyse how Hari Singh's initial strategy reflects both intelligence and moral weakness.

Answer: Hari Singh's initial strategy shows that he is intelligent and observant but morally weak. He changes his name frequently to avoid being recognised by the police and carefully chooses people whom he can deceive. He notices that Anil is simple, trusting and inexperienced with money. However, he uses his intelligence for stealing rather than for an honest purpose. Therefore, his cleverness is accompanied by dishonesty and poor moral judgement.

Question meaning: The question wants two sides: intelligence—how Hari was clever; moral weakness—how he used his cleverness for dishonest purposes.

Quick revision keywords: Intelligent → changed names → observant → chose Anil → clever planning | Moral weakness → lying → stealing → misuse of intelligence → dishonesty

7. How did Hari Singh justify himself stealing Anil's money?

Answer: Hari Singh justified stealing Anil's money by convincing himself that Anil would soon earn the money again. He also thought that stealing was his profession and that there was nothing wrong with taking money from a careless person. However, when he thought about the education Anil was giving him and the trust Anil had placed in him, he realised that education and an honest future were more valuable than the stolen money. This made him return the money.

Question meaning: He tried to make stealing seem acceptable by telling himself that Anil would earn the money again and that stealing was his profession. His conscience later made him realise that education and Anil's trust were more valuable.

Quick revision keywords: Anil will earn again → stealing = profession → careless Anil → self-justification → conscience → education > money → returned money

NELSON MANDELA: LONG WALK TO FREEDOM

1. Why did the author use the phrase "poor law-abiding citizen to become a criminal" to describe Mandela?

Answer: Mandela used this phrase to explain how the unjust apartheid system transformed ordinary, law-abiding people into people who had to break unjust laws in order to fight for their rights. He himself had once believed in obeying laws, but when he realised that the laws were designed to oppress Black people, he joined the struggle against them. Thus, the oppressive system itself forced people to resist.

Question meaning: Why did Mandela, who once obeyed the law, eventually have to break unjust laws? The important idea is apartheid: the laws themselves were unjust and discriminated against Black people.

Quick revision keywords: Apartheid → unjust laws → discrimination → Black people oppressed → laws themselves unjust → resistance

2. According to Mandela, "Emancipation is not merely political." Elaborate.

Answer: According to Mandela, political freedom alone is not sufficient for true emancipation. A person must also be free from poverty, discrimination, fear and other forms of oppression. True freedom means that every person can live with dignity and equal opportunities. Mandela therefore believed that political liberation must be accompanied by social and economic equality.

Question meaning: "Emancipation" means freedom or liberation. The question asks whether political freedom alone is enough for a person to be truly free.

Quick revision keywords: Political freedom + complete freedom → poverty → discrimination → fear → oppression → dignity → equality → true freedom

3. Comment on the reactions and feelings of Lencho and Mandela when they face challenges in their life.

Answer: Lencho and Mandela both face difficult situations, but their responses are different. Lencho remains hopeful and has complete faith in God after his crops are destroyed. Mandela faces racial discrimination and oppression with courage and determination. While Lencho depends on his faith for hope, Mandela takes responsibility and fights against injustice. Both characters demonstrate strong determination in difficult circumstances.

Question meaning: Compare how Lencho and Mandela react when life becomes difficult: Lencho has faith in God and remains hopeful; Mandela faces oppression with courage and fights for freedom.

Quick revision keywords: Lencho → crop destroyed → faith in God → hope | Mandela → apartheid → courage → determination → fight for freedom

4. “No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin or his background or his religion.” Do you agree? Elaborate.

Answer: Yes, I agree with Mandela. Hatred based on colour, background or religion is not something people are born with. It is generally learned from society, prejudice and discriminatory beliefs. Mandela explains that if people can be taught to hate, they can also be taught to love. Therefore, education, equality and understanding can help remove hatred and discrimination from society.

Question meaning: Do you agree that people are not naturally born with hatred toward other groups? Mandela’s idea is that people learn hatred from society; if hatred can be learned, love and tolerance can also be learned.

Quick revision keywords: Not born with hatred → learned from society → prejudice → conditioning → love also learned → education → tolerance → equality

5. How does Mandela use narrative techniques in Long Walk to Freedom to make his experience and the struggle against apartheid engaging and meaningful for readers?

Answer: Mandela uses personal experiences, reflections and vivid descriptions to make his narrative meaningful. He describes important historical events through his own experiences and feelings. He also contrasts the lives of the oppressed with the privileges of the oppressors. His reflections on courage, freedom and sacrifice help readers understand the human cost of apartheid. This combination of personal storytelling and historical context makes the chapter engaging and powerful.

Question meaning: “Narrative techniques” means the way Mandela tells the story. These include personal experiences, memories, descriptions, reflections, historical background and contrast between oppression and freedom.

Quick revision keywords: Personal experiences → memories → reflections → descriptions → historical context → contrast → courage → freedom → sacrifice

6. Mandela said, “People must learn to hate and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love.” Discuss.

Answer: Mandela means that hatred is not natural or inborn. People learn hatred from their surroundings, prejudice and social conditioning. Since hatred can be learned, love and compassion can also be taught. Mandela’s belief in humanity is evident because, despite experiencing oppression, he chose reconciliation rather than revenge. His statement highlights the power of education and human values to overcome hatred.

Question meaning: What does Mandela mean when he says hatred is learned and therefore love can also be learned? Society can teach prejudice, while education can teach tolerance and love.

Quick revision keywords: Hatred learned → surroundings → prejudice → conditioning → love can be taught → compassion → education → humanity

7. How can Mandela’s vision of liberating both the oppressed and oppressor be applied in modern-day society to address issues of inequality and discrimination?

Answer: Mandela’s vision can be applied by promoting equality, justice, education and respect for every individual. Society should work to remove discrimination based on caste, religion, gender, race or economic status. At the same time, people who hold prejudiced beliefs should also be educated and encouraged to change. Mandela’s vision reminds us that true freedom is achieved when both the oppressed and the oppressor are freed from discrimination

and hatred.

Question meaning: How can Mandela's ideas help us solve discrimination and inequality today? Connect the chapter to equal rights, education, removing discrimination, respecting everyone and changing prejudiced attitudes.

Quick revision keywords: Equality → justice → education → equal rights → remove discrimination → respect → change prejudice → freedom for both

8. Does Mandela think the oppressor is free? Why and why not?

Answer: No. Mandela does not believe that the oppressor is truly free. The oppressor may have political and social power, but he is trapped by hatred, prejudice, fear and narrow-mindedness. Mandela believes that both the oppressed and the oppressor must be freed from injustice and from the attitudes that deny freedom to others. Thus, the oppressor also needs liberation.

Question meaning: Is a person who oppresses others actually free? Mandela's answer is no because the oppressor is also trapped by hatred, prejudice, fear and narrow-mindedness.

Quick revision keywords: No → power ≠ true freedom → hatred → prejudice → fear → narrow-mindedness → oppressor also needs liberation

9. What twin obligations does Mandela mention?

Answer: Mandela mentions two obligations. The first is an obligation towards his family, parents, wife and children. The second is an obligation towards his people, community and country. Under apartheid, fulfilling the first obligation became difficult because the struggle for freedom required sacrifices. Eventually, Mandela chose to fight for the freedom of his people because he understood that his people's freedom was connected to his own freedom.

Question meaning: "Twin" means two. The two responsibilities are: responsibility towards his family and responsibility towards his people/country.

Quick revision keywords: TWO responsibilities → Family: parents/wife/children → People: community/country → freedom struggle

FIRE AND ICE

1. How does the poet use extreme symbols to warn against self-destructive emotions?

Answer: Robert Frost uses fire and ice as symbols of destructive human emotions. Fire represents desire, greed, passion and uncontrolled craving, while ice represents hatred, coldness and indifference. The poet suggests that either extreme can destroy humanity. Through these symbols, Frost warns that uncontrolled desire and hatred can become self-destructive forces.

Question meaning: How do "fire" and "ice" represent dangerous human emotions? Fire means desire, greed and passion; ice means hatred and coldness.

Quick revision keywords: Fire → desire → greed → passion → destruction | Ice → hatred → coldness → indifference → destruction

2. How does Frost use the idea or scenario of the world perishing twice? Critically analyse the dualistic fatal nature of humanity.

Answer: Frost imagines that the world could perish in two ways: through fire or through ice. Fire symbolises uncontrolled desire, greed and passion, while ice represents hatred and emotional coldness. The two opposite elements represent two different but equally destructive aspects of human nature. By presenting both possibilities, Frost suggests that humanity itself can become responsible for its destruction through uncontrolled emotions.

Question meaning: The world can perish in two ways: fire and ice. These represent opposite but equally destructive human emotions.

Quick revision keywords: Fire → desire/greed/passion | Ice → hatred/coldness → two opposite emotions → equally destructive → humanity

3. Evaluate the symbolism of fire and ice as metaphors for the transition of cold-blooded malice in humanity.

Answer: Fire and ice represent two forms of destructive human behaviour. Fire symbolises intense desire, greed and uncontrolled passion, whereas ice symbolises hatred, cruelty and cold-heartedness. Both emotions can gradually destroy relationships and humanity. Thus, Frost uses these natural elements as metaphors to show how destructive emotions can grow within human beings and ultimately cause destruction.

Question meaning: Explain what fire and ice symbolise about destructive human emotions: fire represents strong desire and passion; ice represents hatred, cruelty and emotional coldness.

Quick revision keywords: Fire → desire/greed/passion | Ice → hatred/cruelty/cold-heartedness → destructive emotions → humanity

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5. Robert Frost’s view of nature changes when he talks positively in Dust of Snow but negatively in Fire and Ice. Justify this treatment.

Answer: Robert Frost presents two different aspects of nature according to the message of each poem. In Dust of Snow, nature has a positive and healing influence. The falling snow from the hemlock tree changes the poet’s sad mood and makes him feel that he can still enjoy the remaining part of the day. In Fire and Ice, however, nature becomes a symbol of destruction. Fire and ice represent human emotions such as desire and hatred, which can destroy individuals and even humanity. Therefore, Frost’s treatment of nature is not contradictory; he uses nature according to the emotional and philosophical purpose of each poem. Nature can bring hope and renewal, but its elements can also represent destructive forces.

Question meaning: Why does Frost show nature as helpful in one poem but destructive in another? The poems have different messages, so nature is used differently.

Quick revision keywords: Not contradictory → different purposes | Dust of Snow → nature heals → sad mood → happiness | Fire and Ice → nature symbolises emotions → desire/hatred → destruction

6. Discuss how the poet’s personal experience and simple tone reinforce the idea that humanity is primarily responsible for its own demise.

Answer: In Fire and Ice, Frost uses personal reflections and a simple, conversational tone to express a serious idea about humanity. He connects fire with desire because he has experienced the destructive power of excessive human desire. He then considers ice, or hatred, equally capable of causing destruction. The poem’s simple language makes this profound idea easy to understand. Instead of using complicated descriptions, Frost presents the possibility of destruction through familiar natural elements. The real danger lies in human emotions and behaviour, not in fire or ice themselves. Thus, Frost suggests that humanity may be responsible for its own downfall because uncontrolled desire, greed, hatred and coldness can become destructive forces.

Question meaning: Personal experience = what Frost himself has experienced or observed. Simple tone = he expresses the idea in simple conversational language. Humanity is responsible for its own demise = humans can destroy themselves through their own emotions and actions.

Quick revision keywords: Personal observation → simple conversational tone → easy message | Human desire/greed → Fire | Human hatred/coldness → Ice | Extreme emotions → destruction → humans responsible for own demise

DUST OF SNOW + FIRE AND ICE — COMPARISON

Both poems, Dust of Snow and Fire and Ice, use contrasting elements of nature to convey their respective messages about life and human emotions, but they do it differently. Examine their differences.

Answer: Both poems use elements of nature, but they present them in very different ways. In Dust of Snow, the natural elements—a hemlock tree, crow and snow—have a positive effect on the poet. A simple moment in nature changes his mood and saves the rest of his day from being wasted. In Fire and Ice, nature is used negatively and symbolically. Fire represents desire and uncontrolled passion, while ice represents hatred and coldness. Both are shown as forces capable of destroying the world. Thus, Dust of Snow presents nature as a source of healing and transformation, whereas Fire and Ice uses nature to symbolise destructive human emotions.

Question meaning: Compare how nature is used differently in the two poems. Dust of Snow: nature changes the poet's mood positively. Fire and Ice: nature is used as symbols of destruction.

Quick revision keywords: Dust of Snow → nature → positive → mood changes → hope → renewal | Fire and Ice → nature symbolic → fire/desire → ice/hatred → destruction | One = healing; other = destruction